

**SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA
COUNTY OF VENTURA**

Tentative Ruling

**2024CUMC027499: VENTURA UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT, et al. vs PRISCILLA
VINCENNES, et al.**

08/10/2026 in Department 43

**Motion to Compel FURTHER ANSWERS TO INTERROGATORIES REGARDING
PRISCILLA VINCENNES**

The morning calendar in courtroom 43 will normally begin at 8:45. Please arrive for your hearing no later than 8:30 a.m. The door will be opened before the calendar is called.

The Court allows remote appearances by Zoom. Refer to the Courtroom 43 webpage for more information about remote appearances. For Zoom appearances, all counsel appearing by Zoom must register no later than 3:00 p.m. the court day before the hearing. If appearing by Zoom, log into the hearing no later than 8:30 a.m. The Court will transfer you to the meeting room when the calendar begins. Additional instructions can be found on the Court website. When you log in to Zoom, be sure that your name and the case name are used as your Zoom name.

With respect to the tentative ruling below, no notice of intent to appear is required. If you wish to submit on the tentative ruling you can fax notice to Judge Coats's secretary, Ms. Brantner at 805-477-8790, stating that you submit on the tentative. Or you may email Courtroom43@ventura.courts.ca.gov with all counsel copied on the email. Do not call in lieu of sending a fax or email. If you submit on the tentative without appearing and the opposing party appears, the hearing will be conducted in your absence. If you are the moving party and do not advise the Court that you submit on the tentative, or you do not appear at the hearing, the Court may deny your motion irrespective of the tentative.

Unless stated otherwise at the hearing, if a formal order is required but not signed at the hearing, the prevailing party shall prepare a proposed order and comply with CRC 3.1312 subdivisions (a), (b), (d) and (e). The signed order shall be served on all parties and a proof of service filed with the court. A "notice of ruling" in lieu of this procedure is not authorized.

Motions:

1. Plaintiffs Motions to Compel Further Responses from Defendant Imelda Marie Vincennes to Interrogatories, Inspection Demands and Requests for Admission
2. Plaintiffs Motions to Compel Further Responses from Defendant Priscilla Vincennes to Interrogatories, Inspection Demands and Requests for Admission

Tentative Rulings:

Re: Imelda Marie Vincennes

The Court notes that pursuant to the Court's request, the parties met and conferred in good faith and submitted a joint report regarding the result of their efforts. The report reflects that Defendant

**2024CUMC027499: VENTURA UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT, et al. vs PRISCILLA
VINCENNES, et al.**

Imelda Marie Vincennes agreed to supplement her responses to Request for Admission 1, 2, and 5; Form Interrogatory 2.12, 14.1; Special Interrogatory 16; Request for Production 1-4, 6-8, 11-18, and to provide a code-compliant privilege log for withheld documents. The court orders those responses and the privilege log to be served on or before September 11, 2026.

1A. Motion to Compel Further Responses of Imelda Marie Vincennes to Interrogatories:

1B. Motion to Compel Motion to Compel Further Responses of Imelda Marie Vincennes to Requests for Admission:

1C. Motion to Compel Further Responses of Imelda Marie Vincennes to Request for Production of Documents.

These motions are granted in part and Defendant Imelda Marie Vincennes is ordered to provide further verified responses to the following:

1A. Form Interrogatories 2.6, 15.1 (regarding general denial, the Court is unaware of any authority that would excuse a response to the interrogatory), 17.1 (as to Request for Admission 1(b), 2(b), 3(c), 4(c), 8(b-d), 9 (b-d), 10 (b-d), 13(b-d), 14(b-d), 15(b-d)).

Special Interrogatories 1; 3-13 and 15.

1B. The Court could not locate a status report or current information regarding the Requests for Admission at issue, so the motion is denied.

1C. RFP #9 subject to the narrowed scope: “Mound Elementary, Emily Stratton, the events leading to the July 21-22 fire, the fire, the investigation, juvenile proceedings, and this litigation, excluding unrelated personal communications”; RFP #10 Subject to the narrowed scope: “the fire, the investigation, juvenile proceedings, damages, and this litigation, excluding attorney communications and unrelated personal communications.”; and 19-25.

(Code Civ. Proc., §§2030.300; 2031.310.)

The court orders these further responses to be served on or before September 11, 2026.

The motion re: Form Interrogatory 17.1 is denied as to RFA 5, 11, 12.

Monetary sanctions are awarded to moving party in the amount of \$3,000 payable jointly by Plaintiff Imelda Marie Vincennes and counsel on or before September 30, 2026. (Code Civ. Proc., §§2030.300; 2031.310, 2033.290.)

Re: Priscilla Vincennes

The Court notes that pursuant to the Court’s request, the parties met and conferred in good faith and submitted a joint report regarding the result of their efforts. The report reflects that Defendant Priscilla Vincennes agreed to supplement her responses to Request for Admission 30, 31, 33, 35

**2024CUMC027499: VENTURA UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT, et al. vs PRISCILLA
VINCENNES, et al.**

and 36; Form Interrogatory 2.12, 14.1; 17.1 (as to RFA 4, 5, 14, 15, 17, 18, 20, 21, 30, 31, and 35-42); Request for Production 1-4; 11-12; 15-18. The court orders those responses to be served on or before September 11, 2026.

2A. Motion to Compel Further Responses of Priscilla Vincennes to Interrogatories:

2B. Motion to Compel Motion to Compel Further Responses of Priscilla Vincennes to Requests for Admission:

2C. Motion to Compel Further Responses of Priscilla Vincennes to Request for Production of Documents.

Plaintiff withdrew the motion as to Special Interrogatories 1-18.

The motions are granted in part and Defendant Priscilla Vincennes is ordered to provide further verified responses to the following:

2A. Form Interrogatories: 2.6, 2.7, 15.1.

2B. Requests for Admission: 5, 14, 37, 40-42.

2C. Requests for Production: 19-25.

(Code Civ. Proc., §§2030.300; 2031.310, 2033.290.)

The court orders those further responses to be served on or before September 11, 2026.

The motion is DENIED as to Form Interrogatory 17.1. The underlying RFAs were not provided. The court was unable to evaluate the sufficiency of the responses in subsection (b) of 17.1.

Monetary sanctions are awarded to moving party in the amount of \$3,000 payable jointly by Plaintiff Priscilla Vincennes and counsel. (§§2030.300; 2031.310, 2033.290.)

Moving party is ordered to serve notice of the Court's ruling.